

Dean Graham

Sales enablement portfolio

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Eight pieces of work from my time at iplicit, a UK mid-market finance software company, between 2024 and 2026. Each one starts with the situation, what I built and what it led to, followed by extracts from the material itself.

Client names, internal targets and colleagues' names have been removed. I'm happy to talk through any of these in more detail.

1 SDR onboarding programme

Twelve weeks in three phases, from new starter to fully ramped

2 Qualification question bank

What to ask a prospect, and why each answer matters

3 Partner cheat sheet and confidence kit

Positioning and referral messaging for accountancy and reseller partners

4 Pitch deck, buyer personas and AI deck builder

A problem-first deck, tailored by industry and buyer

5 SDR Soundcheck & Spotlight

A coaching rhythm built on real calls, with a way to measure it

6 Diagnosing an SDR performance gap

Case study: data, interviews and call analysis turned into a programme

7 Finance Gap Finder

An interactive partner tool that turns client confidence scores into ranked gaps

8 Navigating the org chart: the W and the M

Two routes through a buying committee, and when to use each

SDR onboarding programme

The *iplicit* SDR Onboarding Handbook, November 2025

SITUATION

New SDRs were taking around four weeks to book their first meeting. With the team growing quickly, every new starter needed the same clear route to being fully ramped.

WHAT I BUILT

A twelve-week programme in three phases: Learn, Prove and Produce. Each month sets out what the new starter will master, what they will do and what “good” looks like by the end of it. Outbound calling starts in week two rather than after training finishes.

WHAT CHANGED

Time to first meeting fell from four weeks to two, then to four days over about ten more starters. After each one I asked the new hire and their manager what had helped and changed the pacing. Meetings per SDR rose from 6 to 8 a month while the team more than doubled.

FROM THE HANDBOOK

Months 1 and 2 shown

Month 1 · Learn	Foundations	Month 2 · Prove	Results	Month 3 · Produce	Not shown
MONTH 1 Learn Focus: Foundations, confidence, and controlled outbound. This month is about building your foundations and getting comfortable operating in a real sales environment. You'll learn <i>iplicit</i>'s story, product fundamentals, our ICPs, and the problems our prospects face. You'll start outbound early, practice call frameworks, and begin speaking to real prospects. By the end of Month 1, you should be able to confidently explain why organisations choose <i>iplicit</i>, run basic outbound activity without hesitation, and book your first meeting through consistent, well-researched outreach. WHAT YOU'LL MASTER ● <i>iplicit</i> story and product fundamentals ● ICPs and personas ● Value proposition: why prospects choose <i>iplicit</i> ● Research fundamentals and call/email basics ● Intro to tools: HubSpot, Apollo, Attention.io WHAT YOU'LL DO ● Shadow SDRs, AEs, and real customer calls ● Learn calling frameworks ● Start early outbound (week 2 onwards) ● Practice objection handling and call structure ● Build your first personal prospect list END-OF-MONTH OUTCOMES ☐ Can explain <i>iplicit</i> clearly and confidently ☐ Sends well-researched, relevant outreach ☐ Handles basic objections with composure ☐ Books your first meeting ☐ Demonstrates ownership, resilience, and pace		MONTH 2 Prove Focus: Apply skills, deliver results, and improve quality. Now you turn knowledge into results. This month is about improving call quality, sharpening your messaging, and demonstrating that you can generate pipeline consistently. You'll deliver cleaner handoffs, work closely with AEs, and use tools like Attention.io to improve your conversations. You're expected to show discipline in your daily routines, understand vertical-specific pain points, and hit a steady meeting target. By the end of Month 2, you should be operating with confidence, accuracy, and visible momentum. WHAT YOU'LL MASTER ● Advanced outbound execution ● Persona-specific messaging (CFO, FD, Head of Finance) ● <i>iplicit</i>'s competitive positioning (Sage50/200, Intacct, Xero, Exchequer) ● Vertical relevance ● Strong objection handling and call control WHAT YOU'LL DO ● Run structured daily prospecting blocks ● Keep HubSpot pipeline clean and accurate ● Collaborate with AEs for strong handoffs ● Review and improve calls using Attention.io END-OF-MONTH OUTCOMES ☐ Books consistent meetings (4+ for the month) ☐ Demonstrates steady call quality and talk track control ☐ Produces clean, high-quality handoffs ☐ Applies vertical insights in messaging			

Qualification question bank

SDR Technical Qualification Questions and Explanations

SITUATION

SDRs were expected to qualify a prospect's technical fit as well as budget, authority, need and timing before passing a meeting to an AE.

WHAT I BUILT

Twenty-four questions grouped by company structure, current system, stock, functional needs and buying process. Every question comes with a short explanation of why it's worth asking and what the answer tells you. For example, the number of legal entities points straight to consolidation pain.

WHY IT MATTERS

It turns product strengths into questions a prospect can answer in their own words. SDRs could hold a credible conversation with a finance director without deep product knowledge, and the AE they were paired with started from a clearer picture of the prospect's pain.

FROM THE QUESTION BANK

Two of five sections shown

Company structure & size

These questions help gauge the complexity of the business and whether implicit is a good fit.

- 1 **How many legal entities are there in total?**
WHY ASK: implicit's multi-entity consolidation is a **key strength**. Understanding the number of entities helps determine if the prospect struggles with manual consolidation, intercompany transactions, and reporting across multiple entities.
- 2 **Are all the entities UK based?**
WHY ASK: If entities are international, implicit's multi-currency and multi-jurisdiction capabilities (e.g., handling VAT/GST differences) may be relevant.
- 3 **Where are the entities located?**
WHY ASK: Helps identify whether cross-border operations require compliance with different tax regimes, foreign exchange handling, or localisation needs.
- 4 **How many employees are there within the organization?**
WHY ASK: Determines the scale of the company and whether they need a system that can support multiple users, approval workflows, and automation at scale.
- 5 **How many make up the core finance team?**
WHY ASK: A small finance team often means they need automation and efficiency, whereas a larger team may require complex user permissions and workflow approvals.
- 6 **What's the revenue for the organisation?**
WHY ASK: Revenue size can indicate complexity in reporting needs, financial controls, and whether they are scaling beyond their current system's capabilities.

Decision-making & buying process

These questions help assess the prospect's authority, timeline, and budget.

- 18 **What is your role within the business?**
WHY ASK: Helps identify whether the contact is a decision-maker or an influencer within the buying process.
- 19 **Would you be managing the project yourself?**
WHY ASK: Determines if they are responsible for implementation or if there is an IT/finance team involved.
- 20 **Who would have final sign-off?**
WHY ASK: Identifies the economic buyer (MEDDIC methodology) and whether they need to be engaged later in the process.
- 21 **Is there a timeframe you're working on?**
WHY ASK: Helps prioritise leads based on urgency—whether they need a system now or are just exploring options.
- 22 **When is your year-end?**
WHY ASK: Year-end is often when companies look to transition systems to align with financial reporting cycles, making it a key factor in deal timing.
- 23 **Are there any other system providers you're looking at?**
WHY ASK: Knowing competitors in the mix helps frame implicit's differentiation early in the conversation.
- 24 **Is there a formal budget you're working with?**
WHY ASK: Determines affordability and whether pricing could be a barrier, allowing SDRs to navigate objections early.

Questions 7–17 cover current system, stock and functional needs.

Partner cheat sheet and confidence kit

Partner-facing enablement, December 2025

SITUATION

Accountancy and reseller partners are often the first to notice when a client has outgrown their finance system. They aren't product experts, though, and won't read long material before a client conversation.

WHAT I BUILT

Two levels of the same message. A short cheat sheet covering who the product is for, the triggers to listen for, the one-liner, and what to say when asked about price, integration or implementation. A fuller confidence kit with proof points, referral wording and answers to common client worries.

HOW IT WAS USED

It was built so that every partner tells the same story, whatever their sector or experience. I also used the kit as the basis for a practical hiring exercise, asking learning-content candidates how they would turn it into training partners would use mid-conversation.

CHEAT SHEET

Sections 6–9

CONFIDENCE KIT

Section 3

THE IPLICIT ONE-LINER (MOST IMPORTANT LINE TO MEMORISE)

"iplicit gives you enterprise-grade capability without enterprise-grade cost, complexity, or timelines."

SIGNS A CLIENT IS A STRONG FIT

Partners should immediately lean in when clients mention:

"Month-end takes too long."

"We rely on spreadsheets for consolidation."

"We've outgrown Sage 50 / Xero."

"We need better approvals and controls."

"Our systems don't talk to each other."

"ERP is too big or too expensive."

"We're adding new sites/entities."

"Audits are painful."

"Reporting isn't real-time."

IF THE CLIENT ASKS ABOUT INTEGRATION

"iplicit is API-first and integrates with the systems you rely on — CRM, EPOS, payroll, TMS, ticketing, stock, expense tools, banking and more. You keep what works; iplicit becomes the finance hub."

IF THE CLIENT ASKS ABOUT IMPLEMENTATION

"With one of the fastest implementation times in the market, most customers go live in weeks, not years. UK-based delivery, clear timelines, no ERP-style disruption."

Key triggers that say "This client is ready for iplicit"

This section helps you quickly recognise when a client is likely to benefit from iplicit, without needing deep technical knowledge or a detailed discovery process. The triggers highlight the practical signs that an organisation has outgrown its current finance system — whether that's operational strain, manual work, growth pressures, or reporting limitations. Use this list as a simple checklist during your conversations or reviews. If a client shows several of these indicators, it's a strong signal that introducing iplicit will add genuine value to them and strengthen your advisory relationship.

OPERATIONAL TRIGGERS

8

- ☐ Multi-entity growth or new subsidiaries
- ☐ Heavy Excel use for reporting or consolidation
- ☐ Too much manual month-end work
- ☐ Restricted/unrestricted funds complexity
- ☐ Inventory or project tracking limitations
- ☐ Approval processes happening via email/Teams
- ☐ Bank rec or AP choking the finance team
- ☐ High dependency on "that one person who knows the system"

TECHNOLOGY TRIGGERS

3

- ☐ They run Xero, Sage 50, QuickBooks, or an ageing on-prem system
- ☐ Need for deeper integrations with CRM, stock, HR, billing
- ☐ Making decisions off delayed / inconsistent data

BEHAVIOURAL TRIGGERS

3

- ☐ CFO/FD showing frustration with inefficiency
- ☐ Leadership pushing for scalability
- ☐ Team drowning in admin

3

If you spot three, iplicit is a fit and should be scoped

5

If you spot five, it should be an instant referral

Pitch deck, buyer personas and AI deck builder

Partner sales deck (20 slides) and buyer persona set

SITUATION

Our team and partners were pitching to finance leaders across very different sectors, from financial services to theatres and hire companies. Each conversation needed the message tailored to that buyer.

WHAT I BUILT

A deck that starts with the buyer's problem before it gets to the product, with sector pages and sections on implementation, support and security. Behind it sits a set of buyer personas, from CFO to IT director, setting out each one's goals, frustrations and who influences them.

WHAT CHANGED

I coached reps on running the deck, then built an AI deck builder that produces a pre-approved deck in moments, tailored to the prospect's sales stage, industry and persona. All eight AEs and our three partner account managers used it.

The Three Problems Holding Mid-Market Finance Teams Back.

THE PROBLEMS BEHIND THE PAIN

1

Processes Held Together by Spreadsheets and Workarounds

Finance teams lose hours every month patching holes your legacy system can't handle — manual journals, duplicated data, clunky reporting, and endless re-checking just to stay afloat.

2

Stagnant Legacy Systems Blocking Growth

Whether you're stuck on old on-premise tools or outgrowing entry-level software, the outcome is the same: slow reporting, rising costs, painful upgrades, and zero support for multi-entity or complex operations.

3

Integration Pain and Never-Ending Projects

Every new system means rewriting rules, rebuilding mappings, and funding bespoke connectors. Projects stall, partners disagree, and nothing ever integrates cleanly.

Leading with the problem

Bridging the Mid-Market Gap.

THE UK'S LEADING MID-MARKET SOLUTION

iplicit offers a smart alternative — freeing organisations from legacy & entry level software *without* the expense and complexity of traditional ERP solutions.

Entry - Level

Mid-Market

Enterprise

Price	Functional	Implementation	Time

Price	Functional	Implementation	Time

Price	Functional	Implementation	Time

Positioning against entry-level and enterprise systems

Implementation Methodology.

FAST, PREDICTABLE, LOW-FRICTION DELIVERY

1 - Onboard

- Planning
- Project Kick-off
- Introduction to Teamwork

2 - Design

- Sandbox Creation
- Solution Design
- Data Collection

3 - Build

- Build Workshops
- Configuration walkthrough
- QA of Build

4 - Train

- User training sessions

5 - Test

- User acceptance testing
- UAT support
- Readiness to deploy

6 - Deploy

- Provision life system
- Opening Balances
- Go live support

7 - Complete

- Lessons learned
- Project closedown
- Customer Success

Implementation features:

- 22 days on average
- Project manager & access to Teamwork project portal
- Specialist resources dedicated for the life of the project

INDICATIVE TIMELINE

Week 1	Weeks 2-3	Weeks 4-6	Weeks 7-9	Weeks 10-12	Weeks 13-15	Week 16
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PAYMENT MILESTONES

- Contract signature
- Completion of Build QA
- Completion of Training
- Completion of Deployment

Making implementation feel predictable

Director of Finance

Joanna

Level Head, Decision-Maker

Responsibilities

At a *small- to medium-sized* general business company with limited resources, the Director of Finance uses their experience to manage complex financial operations, sometimes without any formal accounting training. Budget constraints mean that they often require external accounting help. This limitation also means that, although are technologically savvy regarding adopting new systems, they rely heavily on Excel and manual processes.

In the *not-for-profit* sector the added requirements for complex government grants, funding rules, and compliance stretch an already limited staff and budget. The Director of Finance is frequently a team of one or two, relying on interns and volunteers, and also lacks robust data analysis capabilities, making it difficult and time-consuming

Frustrations

- Budget constraints and complex funding & compliance requirements make it hard to prioritize spending
- Reliance on interns and volunteers makes it difficult to cultivate and manage a strong team
- Manual data entry is a constant challenge causing errors, rework, and costly delays
- Limited IT and customer support adds complexity to daily tasks
- Meeting reporting and auditing mandates is difficult due to a lack of modern, integrated general ledger and HR tools

Winning Their Business

- Demo comprehensive integrated GL, Reporting, Dashboards, Funds
- Underscore easy integration and setup, and access to testing environments/sandboxes resulting in lower employee training needs
- Show how friendly UI and built-in learning enable employee self-help and development
- Demonstrate FPA tools and dashboards that offer easy snapshots and visualizations of the metrics and data they really need to know
- Point out reliable training and customer support options

Decision Making & Influencers

- Own Experience
- Colleagues
- Board
- Professional Forums, Advocacy Groups, Industrial Reports
- Vendors & Consultants
- Google/Internet

Buyer persona: Director of Finance

SDR Soundcheck & Spotlight

A coaching model and measurement framework for the SDR team

SITUATION

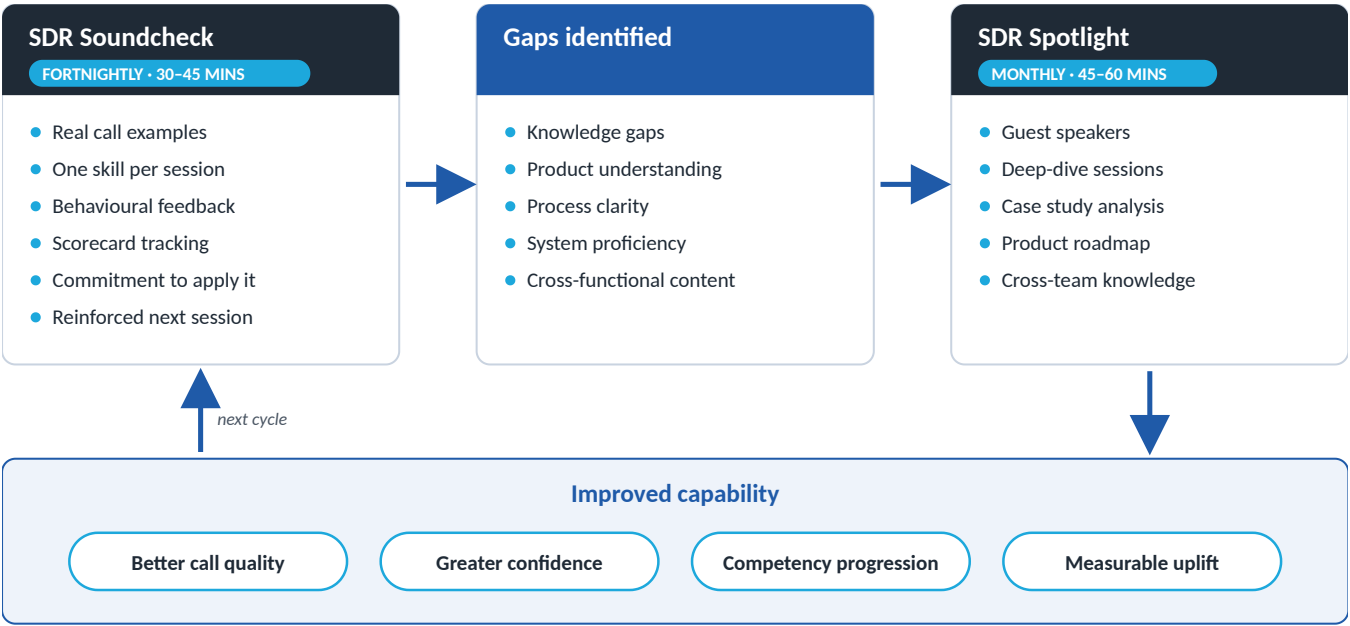
Call listening and team sessions had happened, but not consistently, and they were hard to link to any particular skill gap.

WHAT I BUILT

A fortnightly Soundcheck: thirty to forty-five minutes on one skill, using real calls, with each SDR committing to try it before the next session. The gaps it surfaced shaped a monthly Spotlight session with guest speakers and deeper dives. Enablement designed the system and SDR leadership ran it.

WHAT CHANGED

Average call scores across the team rose from 3.2 to 3.8. It was measured with data the team already had in Attention.io and HubSpot, so it added very little admin.



Designed by
Enablement

Run by
SDR team leadership

Anchored to
The SDR competency framework

The Soundcheck & Spotlight cycle

Measurement layer	The question it answers	Examples of what we tracked
1. Programme health	Are sessions happening, and are people turning up?	Sessions delivered against plan, attendance, topics covered
2. Behavioural adoption	Are SDRs trying what they learned on real calls?	Commitments completed, examples shared at the next session, scorecard trends by skill
3. Competency movement	Are SDRs actually getting better?	Call scores by competency before and after eight weeks, using the same method both times

Diagnosing an SDR performance gap

Case study, 2026

THE BRIEF

The SDR team was falling short of its target of 12 meetings per rep per month. I was asked by the leadership team to find out why and design an enablement programme to close the gap.

WHAT I DID

I combined CRM meeting data, 90 days of call-recording and coaching data, and nine structured interviews with SDRs, team leads, AEs and senior leaders. Every interview followed the same question set, so the answers could be compared.

WHAT I PROPOSED

Five enablement tracks, each with an owner and a measure, starting with quick wins in week one alongside a 90-day build. I also set out clear requests for the issues that sat with other teams.

Learning from the top performer

One SDR was consistently booking more meetings than anyone else. Rather than put it down to territory or luck, I compared more than 160 of their calls with nearly 500 calls from the rest of the team. The difference came down to a handful of habits that could be taught, such as opening with a clear reason to talk, layered discovery instead of a script, reframing objections rather than backing down, and owning the next step instead of offering to send an email. I wrote these up as coaching material for the rest of the team.

Within enablement’s control

- A regular coaching rhythm
- Top-performer habits written down and taught
- A redesigned ramp for new starters
- Foundational call skills

Needing other teams

- Team lead roles and accountability
- How inbound leads were shared out
- The profile used for hiring
- Brand awareness in some sectors

Why I include this: it is how I approach any enablement request. Before building anything, I check what the data and the people closest to the work say the problem really is, and I’m clear about which parts training can fix and which it can’t.

Finance Gap Finder

Interactive partner tool, rebuilt for this portfolio

SITUATION

Partners could spot a client who had outgrown their finance system, but turning that into a structured conversation about what to fix depended on product knowledge most of them didn't have.

WHAT I BUILT

An interactive discovery tool. The partner and the client's finance lead rate their confidence in key finance processes from 0 to 10. Anything scored 6 or below becomes a ranked gap, showing what it costs the client and how iplicit closes it.

WHAT CHANGED

More than 20 referral, reseller and ISV partners used it with their clients in its first quarter, and it was directly attributed to 8 referrals in that time. Partners had a structured way into discovery without needing to be product experts.

THE REBUILT TOOL

Example client shown

RECREATION

This is a rebuild of a partner discovery tool Dean Graham originally created at iplicit. The original is no longer accessible, so it has been recreated for his portfolio. Not an official iplicit product.

PARTNER DISCOVERY TOOL

Where is your client's finance team least confident?

Sit down with the finance lead and rate each process from 0 (not confident at all) to 10 (fully confident). Gaps surface instantly, ranked, with how iplicit closes each one and the question to ask next.

1 Rate confidence

2 Review ranked gaps

3 Copy the summary into your follow-up

Client

Northgate Learning Trust (example)

Current system

Sage 50

Load example

Start fresh

0-3 Critical gap

4-6 Gap

7-10 Confident

RECORD TO REPORT

avg 3.7

Month-end close

We close the month quickly, without late nights or manual journals.

3

0 · Not confident

5

10 · Fully confident

Multi-entity & consolidation

We can consolidate all entities without spreadsheets.

2

CONFIDENCE BY PROCESS

Purchase invoice processing 1

Multi-entity & consolidation 2

Budgeting & forecasting 2

45 out of 100

Clear room to improve

Northgate Learning Trust (example) on Sage 50: weakest in purchase invoice processing and multi-entity & consolidation.

6 critical 4 gaps 4 confident

Confidence is rated process by process, and the overall score and ranking update as each slider moves

HOW IPLICIT CLOSSES THE GAPS · 10

Purchase invoice processing

CRITICAL GAP · 1/10

Manual keying costs hours each week and introduces coding errors.

Purchase invoice automation. Invoices are captured, coded and matched to purchase orders automatically, then routed for approval.

ASK NEXT

Roughly how many supplier invoices do you process a month, and who keys them?

Multi-entity & consolidation

CRITICAL GAP · 2/10

Spreadsheet consolidation is slow, hard to audit and breaks every time the group changes.

Multi-entity by design. Run every entity on one platform with automated inter-entity transactions and consolidated group reporting on demand.

ASK NEXT

How many entities do you report on, and how long does group reporting take each month?

TRY IT

The original tool is no longer accessible, so I rebuilt it to show how it worked. The rebuild is live and works in any browser:

dg-my-portfolio.github.io/Enablement/gap-finder.html

- 1 Rate each finance process from 0 (not confident) to 10 (fully confident)
- 2 Review the gaps, ranked from weakest to strongest
- 3 Copy the summary into a follow-up email to the client

Each gap is paired with how iplicit closes it and the next question to ask

Navigating the org chart: the W and the M

Rep guide to multi-threading a deal, rebuilt for this portfolio

SITUATION

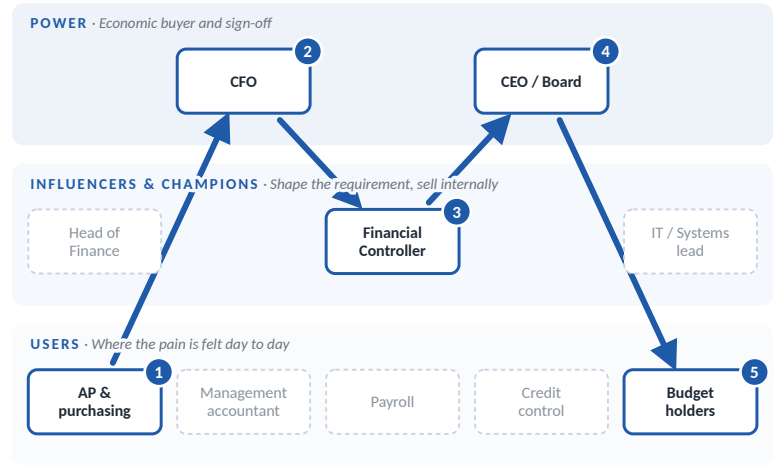
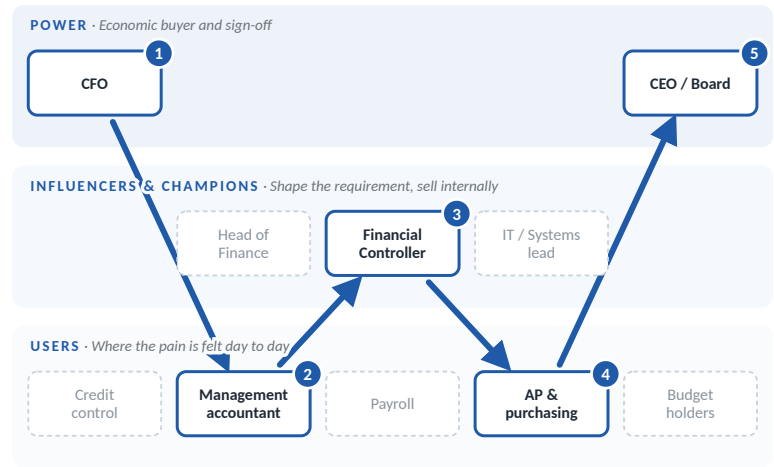
Reps tended to stay with whoever they first got through to. That left deals resting on one contact, and when that person went quiet or lacked authority, the deal stalled.

WHAT I BUILT

A one-page guide that turns multi-threading into a shape a rep can remember. Start at the top and your route through the org chart draws a W. Start at the bottom and it draws an M.

WHY IT WORKS

Reps can sketch it in a deal review and see straight away which levels they haven't reached. It lines up with MEDDIC: the economic buyer sits at the top, the champion in the middle, and the pain usually surfaces at the bottom.



W Start with power

Use it when you can get to the CFO first, through a referral, partner introduction or event.

- 1 CFO**
Open at the top. Agree the business problem and get permission to speak to the team.
- 2 Management accountant**
Go down to the people doing the work and find the detail behind the pain.
- 3 Financial Controller**
Build your champion. Share what you found and test the case together.
- 4 AP & purchasing**
Check it with a second user group so the case doesn't rest on one view.
- 5 CEO / Board**
Return to power with evidence from the team, and the CFO alongside you, to agree sign-off.

M Start with users

Use it when you come in through inbound or outbound with someone who does the work.

- 1 AP & purchasing**
Start where the pain is felt. It's often the easiest way in.
- 2 CFO**
Climb early. Take what you've learned to power before the deal settles at the bottom.
- 3 Financial Controller**
Build your champion, now with the CFO's backing.
- 4 CEO / Board**
Go back to power with the business case and agree the decision process.
- 5 Budget holders**
Confirm fit with the wider users and plan adoption.

THE RULE FOR BOTH

Never let a deal sit on one level. The W starts with authority and earns the detail. The M starts with the detail and has to earn authority, so make the first climb early.